

CHAPTER 4: CREATING NONPLAYER CHARACTERS



NONPLAYER CHARACTER IS ANY CHARACTER controlled by the Dungeon Master. NPCs can be enemies or allies, regular folk or named monsters. They include the local innkeeper, the old wizard who lives in the tower on the outskirts of town, the death knight out to destroy the kingdom, and the dragon counting gold in its cavernous lair.

This chapter shows you how to flesh out nonplayer characters for your game. For guidelines on generating monster-like stat blocks for an NPC, see chapter 9, "Dungeon Master's Workshop."

DESIGNING NPCs

Nothing brings your adventures and campaigns to life better than a cast of well-developed NPCs. That said, NPCs in your game rarely need as much complexity as a well-crafted character in a novel or movie. Most NPCs are bit players in the campaign, whereas the adventurers are the stars.

QUICK NPCs

An NPC doesn't need combat statistics unless it poses a threat. Moreover, most NPCs need only one or two qualities to make them memorable. For example, your players will have no trouble remembering the no-nonsense blacksmith with the tattoo of the black rose on his right shoulder or the badly dressed bard with the broken nose.

DETAILED NPCs

For NPCs who play larger roles in your adventures, allow more time to flesh out their histories and personalities. As you'll see, ten sentences can sum up the main elements of a memorable NPC, one sentence for each of the following:

- Occupation and history
- Appearance
- Abilities
- Talent
- Mannerism
- Interactions with others
- Useful knowledge
- Ideal
- Bond
- Flaw or secret

Although the material here focuses on humanoid NPCs, you can adjust details to create monstrous NPCs as well.

OCCUPATION AND HISTORY

In one sentence, describe the NPC's occupation and provide a brief historical note that hints at the character's past. For example, the NPC might have served in an army, been imprisoned for a crime, or adventured years ago.

APPEARANCE

In one sentence, describe the NPC's most distinctive physical features. You can roll on the NPC Appearance table or choose a feature that suits the character.

NPC APPEARANCE

d20	Feature
1	Distinctive jewelry: earrings, necklace, circlet, bracelets
2	Piercings
3	Flamboyant or outlandish clothes
4	Formal, clean clothes
5	Ragged, dirty clothes
6	Pronounced scar
7	Missing teeth
8	Missing fingers
9	Unusual eye color (or two different colors)
10	Tattoos
11	Birthmark
12	Unusual skin color
13	Bald
14	Braided beard or hair
15	Unusual hair color
16	Nervous eye twitch
17	Distinctive nose
18	Distinctive posture (crooked or rigid)
19	Exceptionally beautiful
20	Exceptionally ugly

ABILITIES

You don't need to roll ability scores for the NPC, but note abilities that are above or below average—great strength or monumental stupidity, for example—and use them to inform the NPC's qualities.

NPC ABILITIES

d6	High Ability
1	Strength—powerful, brawny, strong as an ox
2	Dexterity—lithe, agile, graceful
3	Constitution—hardy, hale, healthy
4	Intelligence—studious, learned, inquisitive
5	Wisdom—perceptive, spiritual, insightful
6	Charisma—persuasive, forceful, born leader
d6	Low Ability
1	Strength—feeble, scrawny
2	Dexterity—clumsy, fumbling
3	Constitution—sickly, pale
4	Intelligence—dim-witted, slow
5	Wisdom—oblivious, absentminded
6	Charisma—dull, boring

TALENT

In one sentence, describe something that your NPC can do that is special, if anything. Roll on the NPC Talents table or use it to spur your own ideas.

NPC TALENTS

d20	Talent
1	Plays a musical instrument
2	Speaks several languages fluently
3	Unbelievably lucky
4	Perfect memory
5	Great with animals
6	Great with children
7	Great at solving puzzles
8	Great at one game
9	Great at impersonations
10	Draws beautifully
11	Paints beautifully
12	Sings beautifully
13	Drinks everyone under the table
14	Expert carpenter
15	Expert cook
16	Expert dart thrower and rock skipper
17	Expert juggler
18	Skilled actor and master of disguise
19	Skilled dancer
20	Knows thieves' cant

MANNERISM

In one sentence, describe one mannerism that will help players remember the NPC. Roll on the NPC Mannerisms and Quirks table or use it to generate your own ideas.

NPC MANNERISMS

d20	Mannerism
1	Prone to singing, whistling, or humming quietly
2	Speaks in rhyme or some other peculiar way
3	Particularly low or high voice
4	Slurs words, lisps, or stutters
5	Enunciates overly clearly
6	Speaks loudly
7	Whispers
8	Uses flowery speech or long words
9	Frequently uses the wrong word
10	Uses colorful oaths and exclamations
11	Makes constant jokes or puns
12	Prone to predictions of doom
13	Fidgets
14	Squints
15	Stares into the distance
16	Chews something
17	Paces
18	Taps fingers
19	Bites fingernails
20	Twirls hair or tugs beard

INTERACTIONS WITH OTHERS

In one sentence, describe how the NPC interacts with others, using the NPC Interaction Traits table if necessary. An NPC's behavior can change depending on who he or she is interacting with. For example, an innkeeper might be friendly toward guests and rude to her staff.

NPC INTERACTION TRAITS

d12	Trait	d12	Trait
1	Argumentative	7	Honest
2	Arrogant	8	Hot tempered
3	Blustering	9	Irritable
4	Rude	10	Ponderous
5	Curious	11	Quiet
6	Friendly	12	Suspicious

USEFUL KNOWLEDGE

In a sentence, describe one bit of knowledge the NPC possesses that might be of use to the player characters. The NPC might know something as banal as the best inn in town or as important as a clue needed to solve a murder.

IDEAL

In a sentence, describe one ideal that the NPC holds dear and which governs his or her greater actions. Player characters who uncover an NPC's ideal can use what they've learned to influence the NPC in a social interaction (as discussed in chapter 8, "Running the Game").

Ideals can connect to alignment, as shown on the NPC Ideals table. The alignment connections here are suggestions only; an evil character could have beauty as an ideal, for instance.

NPC IDEALS

d6	Good Ideal	Evil Ideal
1	Beauty	Domination
2	Charity	Greed
3	Greater good	Might
4	Life	Pain
5	Respect	Retribution
6	Self-sacrifice	Slaughter
d6	Lawful Ideal	Chaotic Ideal
1	Community	Change
2	Fairness	Creativity
3	Honor	Freedom
4	Logic	Independence
5	Responsibility	No limits
6	Tradition	Whimsy
d6	Neutral Ideal	Other Ideals
1	Balance	Aspiration
2	Knowledge	Discovery
3	Live and let live	Glory
4	Moderation	Nation
5	Neutrality	Redemption
6	People	Self-knowledge

BOND

In a sentence, summarize the people, places, or things that are especially important to the NPC. The NPC Bonds table offers suggestions in broad categories.

The character backgrounds in the *Player's Handbook* explore bonds in more detail, and player characters who uncover an NPC's bond can use what they've learned to influence the NPC in a social interaction (as discussed in chapter 8).

NPC BONDS

d10 Bond

- | | |
|----|--|
| 1 | Dedicated to fulfilling a personal life goal |
| 2 | Protective of close family members |
| 3 | Protective of colleagues or compatriots |
| 4 | Loyal to a benefactor, patron, or employer |
| 5 | Captivated by a romantic interest |
| 6 | Drawn to a special place |
| 7 | Protective of a sentimental keepsake |
| 8 | Protective of a valuable possession |
| 9 | Out for revenge |
| 10 | Roll twice, ignoring results of 10 |

FLAW OR SECRET

In one sentence, describe the NPC's flaw—some element of the character's personality or history that could potentially undermine the character—or a secret that the NPC is trying to hide.

The NPC Flaws and Secrets table provides several ideas. The backgrounds in the *Player's Handbook* can be used to create more detailed flaws. Player characters who uncover an NPC's flaw or secret can use what they've learned to influence the NPC in a social interaction (as discussed in chapter 8).

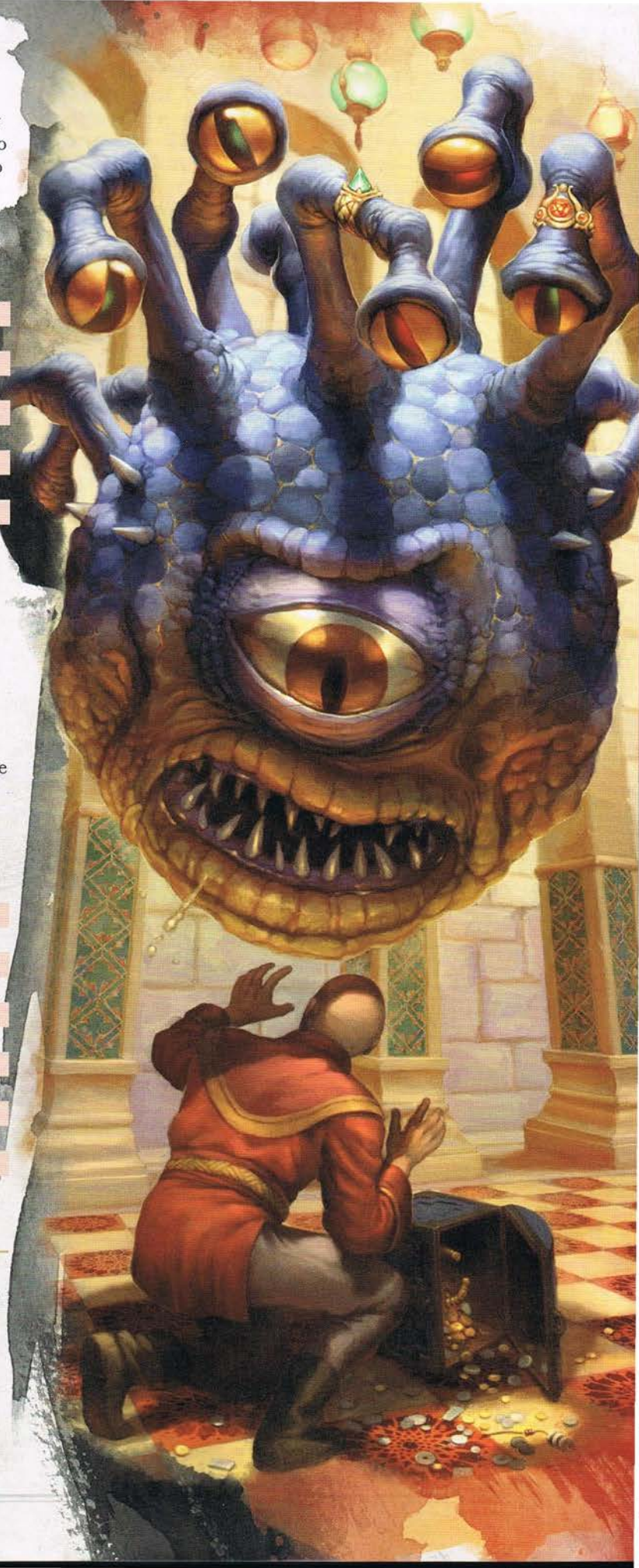
NPC FLAWS AND SECRETS

d12 Flaw or Secret

- | | |
|----|--|
| 1 | Forbidden love or susceptibility to romance |
| 2 | Enjoys decadent pleasures |
| 3 | Arrogance |
| 4 | Envious of another creature's possessions or station |
| 5 | Overpowering greed |
| 6 | Prone to rage |
| 7 | Has a powerful enemy |
| 8 | Specific phobia |
| 9 | Shameful or scandalous history |
| 10 | Secret crime or misdeed |
| 11 | Possession of forbidden lore |
| 12 | Foolhardy bravery |

MONSTERS AS NPCs

Named monsters that play a significant role in an adventure deserve the same attention you would give to a humanoid NPC, with mannerisms as well as ideals, bonds, flaws, and secrets. If a beholder mastermind is behind the criminal activities in a city, don't rely solely on the entry in the *Monster Manual* to describe the creature's appearance and personality. Take the



time to give it a bit of background, a distinctive quirk of appearance, and especially an ideal, a bond, and a flaw.

As an example, consider the Xanathar, a beholder that runs extensive criminal operations in the city of Waterdeep. The Xanathar's spherical body is covered in leathery flesh with a texture similar to cobblestones. Its eyestalks are jointed like the legs of an insect, and some of the stalks have magic rings on them. The Xanathar's speech is slow and deliberate, and it prefers to turn its central eye away from creatures it speaks to. Like all beholders, it sees other creatures as inferiors, though it understands the usefulness of its humanoid minions. The Xanathar uses the sewers beneath Waterdeep to access virtually any location within or under the city.

The Xanathar's ideal is greed. It craves powerful magic items and surrounds itself with gold, platinum, and precious gems. Its bond is to its lair—an elaborate cavern complex carved out between the twisting sewers of Waterdeep, which it inherited from its predecessors and cherishes above all else. Its flaw is a weakness for exotic pleasures: finely prepared foods, scented oils, and rare spices and herbs.

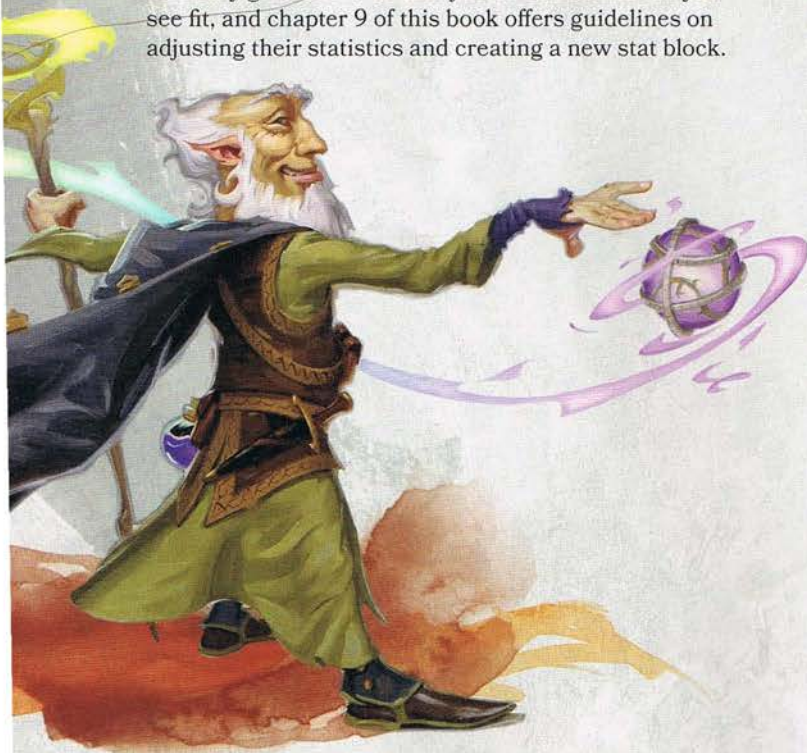
Establishing this information allows you to play the Xanathar as more than an ordinary beholder. The complexities of the creature's characterization create more memorable interaction and interesting story possibilities.

NPC STATISTICS

When you give an NPC game statistics, you have three main options: giving the NPC only the few statistics it needs, give the NPC a monster stat block, or give the NPC a class and levels. The latter two options require a bit of explanation.

USING A MONSTER STAT BLOCK

Appendix B of the *Monster Manual* contains statistics for many generic NPCs that you can customize as you see fit, and chapter 9 of this book offers guidelines on adjusting their statistics and creating a new stat block.



USING CLASSES AND LEVELS

You can create an NPC just as you would a player character, using the rules in the *Player's Handbook*. You can even use a character sheet to keep track of the NPC's vital information.

Class Options. In addition to the class options in the *Player's Handbook*, two additional class options are available for evil player characters and NPCs: the Death domain for clerics and the oathbreaker for paladins. Both options are detailed at the end of this chapter.

Equipment. Most NPCs don't need an exhaustive list of equipment. An enemy meant to be faced in combat requires weapons and armor, plus any treasure the NPC carries (including magic items that might be used against the adventurers).

Challenge Rating. An NPC built for combat needs a challenge rating. Use the rules in chapter 9 to determine the NPC's challenge rating, just as you would for a monster you designed.

NPC PARTY MEMBERS

NPCs might join the adventuring party because they want a share of the loot and are willing to accept an equal share of the risk, or they might follow the adventurers because of a bond of loyalty, gratitude, or love. Such NPCs are controlled by you, or you can transfer control to the players. Even if a player controls an NPC, it's up to you to make sure the NPC is portrayed as a character in his or her own right, not just as a servant that the players can manipulate for their own benefit.

Any NPC that accompanies the adventurers acts as a party member and earns a full share of experience points. When determining the difficulty of a combat encounter (see chapter 3), make sure to include all NPC party members.

LOW-LEVEL FOLLOWERS

Your campaign might allow player characters to take on lower-level NPCs as followers. For example, a paladin might have a 1st-level paladin as a squire, a wizard might accept a 2nd-level wizard as an apprentice, a cleric might choose (or be assigned) a 3rd-level cleric as an acolyte, and a bard might take on a 4th-level bard as an understudy.

One advantage of allowing lower-level characters to join the party is that players have backup characters if their main characters take time off, retire, or die. One disadvantage is that you and your players have more party members to account for.

Since lower-level NPC party members receive equal party shares of XP, they will gain levels more quickly than the adventurers (the benefit of studying under such experienced masters), and might eventually catch up to them. It also means the adventurers' advancement is slowed somewhat, as they must share their XP with an NPC shouldering only part of the adventuring burden.

Powerful monsters that are an appropriate challenge for higher-level characters can deal enough damage to instantly kill or incapacitate a low-level follower. The adventurers should expect to spend effort and resources

protecting lower-level NPC party members and to provide healing when this protection fails.

ADVENTURER NPCs

If you don't have enough players to form a full party, you can use NPCs to fill out the ranks. These NPCs should be the same level as the lowest-level adventurer in the party and built (either by you or your players) using the character creation and advancement rules in the *Player's Handbook*. It's easiest on you if you let the players create and run these supporting characters.

Encourage players to roleplay supporting characters as true to the NPCs' personality traits, ideals, bonds, and flaws as possible, so that they don't come across as automatons. If you don't feel that an NPC is being portrayed well, you can take control of the NPC, give it to another player, or simply have the NPC leave the party.

NPC supporting characters are easier to play if you limit their class options. Good candidates for supporting characters include a cleric with the Life domain, a fighter with the Champion archetype, a rogue with the Thief archetype, and a wizard specializing in Evocation.

OPTIONAL RULE: LOYALTY

Loyalty is an optional rule you can use to determine how far an NPC party member will go to protect or assist the other members of the party (even those he or she doesn't particularly like). An NPC party member who is abused or ignored is likely to abandon or betray the party, whereas an NPC who owes a life debt to the characters or shares their goals might fight to the death for them. Loyalty can be roleplayed or represented by this rule.

LOYALTY SCORE

An NPC's loyalty is measured on a numerical scale from 0 to 20. The NPC's maximum loyalty score is equal to the highest Charisma score among all adventurers in the party, and its starting loyalty score is half that number. If the highest Charisma score changes—perhaps a character dies or leaves the group—adjust the NPC's loyalty score accordingly.

TRACKING LOYALTY

Keep track of an NPC's loyalty score in secret so that the players won't know for sure whether an NPC party member is loyal or disloyal (even if the NPC is currently under a player's control).

An NPC's loyalty score increases by 1d4 if other party members help the NPC achieve a goal tied to its bond. Likewise, an NPC's loyalty score increases by 1d4 if the NPC is treated particularly well (for example, given a magic weapon as a gift) or rescued by another party member. An NPC's loyalty score can never be raised above its maximum.

When other party members act in a manner that runs counter to the NPC's alignment or bond, reduce the NPC's loyalty score by 1d4. Reduce the NPC's loyalty score by 2d4 if the character is abused, misled, or endangered by other party members for purely selfish reasons.

An NPC whose loyalty score drops to 0 is no longer loyal to the party and might part ways with them. A loyalty score can never drop below 0.

An NPC with a loyalty score of 10 or higher risks life and limb to help fellow party members. If the NPC's loyalty score is between 1 and 10, its loyalty is tenuous. An NPC whose loyalty drops to 0 no longer acts in the party's best interests. The disloyal NPC either leaves the party (attacking characters who attempt to intervene) or works in secret to bring about the party's downfall.

CONTACTS

Contacts are NPCs with close ties to one or more of the player characters. They don't go on adventures, but they can provide information, rumors, supplies, or professional advice, either for free or at a cost. Some of the backgrounds in the *Player's Handbook* suggest



contacts for beginning adventurers, and characters are likely to secure more helpful contacts over the course of their adventuring careers.

A name and a few choice details are all you need for casual contacts, but take the time to flesh out a recurring contact, especially one who might become an ally or enemy at some point. At the very least, give some thought to a contact's goals and how those goals are likely to come into play.

PATRONS

A patron is a contact who employs the adventurers, providing help or rewards as well as quests and adventure hooks. Most of the time, a patron has a vested interest in the adventurers' success and doesn't need to be persuaded to help them.

A patron might be a retired adventurer who seeks younger heroes to deal with rising threats, or a mayor who knows that the town guard can't handle a dragon demanding tribute. A sheriff becomes a patron by offering a bounty for kobold raiders terrorizing the local countryside, as does a noble who wants an abandoned estate cleared of monsters.

HIRELINGS

Adventurers can pay NPCs to provide services in a variety of circumstances. Information on hirelings appears in chapter 5, "Equipment," of the *Player's Handbook*.

Hireling NPCs rarely become important in an adventure, and most require little development. When adventurers hire a coach to carry them across town or need a letter delivered, the driver or messenger is a hireling, and the adventurers might never even converse with that NPC or learn his or her name. A ship captain carrying the adventurers across the sea is also a hireling, but such a character has the potential to turn into an ally, a patron, or even an enemy as the adventure unfolds.

When the adventurers hire an NPC for long-term work, add the cost of that NPC's services to the characters' lifestyle expenses. See the "Additional Expenses" section of chapter 6, "Between Adventures," for more information.

EXTRAS

Extras are the characters and creatures in the background that the main characters rarely, if ever, interact with.

Extras might be elevated to more important roles by virtue of adventurers singling them out. For instance, a player might be hooked by a passing reference you make to a street urchin and try to strike up a conversation with the youngster. Suddenly, an extra on whom you placed no importance becomes a central figure in an improvised roleplaying scene.

Whenever extras are present, be prepared to come up with names and mannerisms on the fly. In a pinch, you can plunder the race-specific character names found in chapter 2, "Races," of the *Player's Handbook*.

VILLAINS

By their actions, villains provide job security for heroes. Chapter 3 helps you determine suitable villains for your adventures, while this section helps you flesh out their evil schemes, methods, and weaknesses. Let the tables that follow inspire you.

VILLAIN'S SCHEME

d8	Objective and Scheme
1	<i>Immortality (d4)</i>
1	Acquire a legendary item to prolong life
2	Ascend to godhood
3	Become undead or obtain a younger body
4	Steal a planar creature's essence
2	<i>Influence (d4)</i>
1	Seize a position of power or title
2	Win a contest or tournament
3	Win favor with a powerful individual
4	Place a pawn in a position of power
3	<i>Magic (d6)</i>
1	Obtain an ancient artifact
2	Build a construct or magical device
3	Carry out a deity's wishes
4	Offer sacrifices to a deity
5	Contact a lost deity or power
6	Open a gate to another world
4	<i>Mayhem (d6)</i>
1	Fulfill an apocalyptic prophecy
2	Enact the vengeful will of a god or patron
3	Spread a vile contagion
4	Overthrow a government
5	Trigger a natural disaster
6	Utterly destroy a bloodline or clan
5	<i>Passion (d4)</i>
1	Prolong the life of a loved one
2	Prove worthy of another person's love
3	Raise or restore a dead loved one
4	Destroy rivals for another person's affection
6	<i>Power (d4)</i>
1	Conquer a region or incite a rebellion
2	Seize control of an army
3	Become the power behind the throne
4	Gain the favor of a ruler
7	<i>Revenge (d4)</i>
1	Avenge a past humiliation or insult
2	Avenge a past imprisonment or injury
3	Avenge the death of a loved one
4	Retrieve stolen property and punish the thief
8	<i>Wealth (d4)</i>
1	Control natural resources or trade
2	Marry into wealth
3	Plunder ancient ruins
4	Steal land, goods, or money

VILLAIN'S METHODS

d20	Methods
1	<i>Agricultural devastation (d4)</i>
1	Blight
2	Crop failure
3	Drought
4	Famine
2	Assault or beatings
3	Bounty hunting or assassination
4	<i>Captivity or coercion (d10)</i>
1	Bribery
2	Enticement
3	Eviction
4	Imprisonment
5	Kidnapping
6	Legal intimidation
7	Press gangs
8	Shackling
9	Slavery
10	Threats or harassment
5	<i>Confidence scams (d6)</i>
1	Breach of contract
2	Cheating
3	Fast talking
4	Fine print
5	Fraud or swindling
6	Quackery or tricks
6	<i>Defamation (d4)</i>
1	Framing
2	Gossiping or slander
3	Humiliation
4	Libel or insults
7	Dueling
8	<i>Execution (d8)</i>
1	Beheading
2	Burning at the stake
3	Burying alive
4	Crucifixion
5	Drawing and quartering
6	Hanging
7	Impalement
8	Sacrifice (living)
9	Impersonation or disguise
10	Lying or perjury
11	<i>Magical mayhem (d8)</i>
1	Hauntings
2	Illusions
3	Infernal bargains
4	Mind control
5	Petrification
6	Raising or animating the dead
7	Summoning monsters
8	Weather control

d20	Methods
12	<i>Murder (d10)</i>
1	Assassination
2	Cannibalism
3	Dismemberment
4	Drowning
5	Electrocution
6	Euthanasia (involuntary)
7	Disease
8	Poisoning
9	Stabbing
10	Strangulation or suffocation
13	Neglect
14	<i>Politics (d6)</i>
1	Betrayal or treason
2	Conspiracy
3	Espionage or spying
4	Genocide
5	Oppression
6	Raising taxes
15	<i>Religion (d4)</i>
1	Curses
2	Desecration
3	False gods
4	Heresy or cults
16	Stalking
17	<i>Theft or Property Crime (d10)</i>
1	Arson
2	Blackmail or extortion
3	Burglary
4	Counterfeiting
5	Highway robbery
6	Looting
7	Mugging
8	Poaching
9	Seizing property
10	Smuggling
18	<i>Torture (d6)</i>
1	Acid
2	Blinding
3	Branding
4	Racking
5	Thumbscrews
6	Whipping
19	<i>Vice (d4)</i>
1	Adultery
2	Drugs or alcohol
3	Gambling
4	Seduction
20	<i>Warfare (d6)</i>
1	Ambush
2	Invasion
3	Massacre
4	Mercenaries
5	Rebellion
6	Terrorism



VILLAIN'S SECRET WEAKNESS

Finding and exploiting a villain's weakness can be very gratifying for players, although a smart villain tries to conceal its weakness. A lich, for example, has a phylactery—a magical receptacle for its soul—that it keeps well hidden. Only by destroying the phylactery can the characters ensure the lich's destruction.

VILLAIN'S WEAKNESS

d8	Weakness
1	A hidden object holds the villain's soul.
2	The villain's power is broken if the death of its true love is avenged.
3	The villain is weakened in the presence of a particular artifact.
4	A special weapon deals extra damage when used against the villain.
5	The villain is destroyed if it speaks its true name.
6	An ancient prophecy or riddle reveals how the villain can be overthrown.
7	The villain falls when an ancient enemy forgives its past actions.
8	The villain loses its power if a mystic bargain it struck long ago is completed.

VILLAINOUS CLASS OPTIONS

You can use the rules in the *Player's Handbook* to create NPCs with classes and levels, the same way you create player characters. The class options below let you create two specific villainous archetypes: the evil high priest and the evil knight or antipaladin.

The Death Domain is an additional domain choice for evil clerics, and the Oathbreaker offers an alternative path for paladins who fall from grace. A player can choose one of these options with your approval.

CLERIC: DEATH DOMAIN

The Death domain is concerned with the forces that cause death, as well as the negative energy that gives rise to undead creatures. Deities such as Chemosh, Myrkul, and Wee Jas are patrons of necromancers, death knights, liches, mummy lords, and vampires. Gods of the Death domain also embody murder (Anubis, Bhaal, and Pyremius), pain (Iuz or Loviatar), disease or poison (Incabulos, Talona, or Morgion), and the underworld (Hades and Hel).

DEATH DOMAIN SPELLS

Cleric Level	Spells
1st	<i>false life, ray of sickness</i>
3rd	<i>blindness/deafness, ray of enfeeblement</i>
5th	<i>animate dead, vampiric touch</i>
7th	<i>blight, death ward</i>
9th	<i>antilife shell, cloudkill</i>

BONUS PROFICIENCY

When the cleric chooses this domain at 1st level, he or she gains proficiency with martial weapons.

REAPER

At 1st level, the cleric learns one necromancy cantrip of his or her choice from any spell list. When the cleric casts a necromancy cantrip that normally targets only one creature, the spell can instead target two creatures within range and within 5 feet of each other.

CHANNEL DIVINITY: TOUCH OF DEATH

Starting at 2nd level, the cleric can use Channel Divinity to destroy another creature's life force by touch.

When the cleric hits a creature with a melee attack, the cleric can use Channel Divinity to deal extra necrotic damage to the target. The damage equals 5 + twice his or her cleric level.

INESCAPABLE DESTRUCTION

Starting at 6th level, the cleric's ability to channel negative energy becomes more potent. Necrotic damage dealt by the character's cleric spells and Channel Divinity options ignores resistance to necrotic damage.

DIVINE STRIKE

At 8th level, the cleric gains the ability to infuse his or her weapon strikes with necrotic energy. Once on each of the cleric's turns when he or she hits a creature with a weapon attack, the cleric can cause the attack to deal an extra 1d8 necrotic damage to the target. When the cleric reaches 14th level, the extra damage increases to 2d8.

IMPROVED REAPER

Starting at 17th level, when the cleric casts a necromancy spell of 1st through 5th level that targets only one creature, the spell can instead target two creatures within range and within 5 feet of each other. If the spell consumes its material components, the cleric must provide them for each target.

PALADIN: OATHBREAKER

An Oathbreaker is a paladin who breaks his or her sacred oaths to pursue some dark ambition or serve an evil power. Whatever light burned in the paladin's heart has been extinguished. Only darkness remains.

A paladin must be evil and at least 3rd level to become an Oathbreaker. The paladin replaces the features specific to his or her Sacred Oath with Oathbreaker features.

OATHBREAKER SPELLS

An Oathbreaker paladin loses previously gained oath spells and instead gains the following Oathbreaker spells at the paladin levels listed.

OATHBREAKER SPELLS

Paladin Level	Spells
3rd	<i>hellish rebuke, inflict wounds</i>
5th	<i>crown of madness, darkness</i>
9th	<i>animate dead, bestow curse</i>
13th	<i>blight, confusion</i>
17th	<i>contagion, dominate person</i>

CHANNEL DIVINITY

An Oathbreaker paladin of 3rd level or higher gains the following two Channel Divinity options.

Control Undead. As an action, the paladin targets one undead creature he or she can see within 30 feet of him or her. The target must make a Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the target must obey the paladin's commands for the next 24 hours, or until the paladin

uses this Channel Divinity option again. An undead whose challenge rating is equal to or greater than the paladin's level is immune to this effect.

Dreadful Aspect. As an action, the paladin channels the darkest emotions and focuses them into a burst of magical menace. Each creature of the paladin's choice within 30 feet of the paladin must make a Wisdom saving throw if it can see the paladin. On a failed save, the target is frightened of the paladin for 1 minute. If a creature frightened by this effect ends its turn more than 30 feet away from the paladin, it can attempt another Wisdom saving throw to end the effect on it.

AURA OF HATE

Starting at 7th level, the paladin, as well any fiends and undead within 10 feet of the paladin, gains a bonus to melee weapon damage rolls equal to the paladin's Charisma modifier (minimum of +1). A creature can benefit from this feature from only one paladin at a time.

At 18th level, the range of this aura increases to 30 feet.

SUPERNATURAL RESISTANCE

At 15th level, the paladin gains resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons.

DREAD LORD

At 20th-level, the paladin can, as an action, surround himself or herself with an aura of gloom that lasts for 1 minute. The aura reduces any bright light in a 30-foot radius around the paladin to dim light. Whenever an enemy that is frightened by the paladin starts its turn in the aura, it takes 4d10 psychic damage. Additionally, the paladin and creatures he or she chooses in the aura are draped in deeper shadow. Creatures that rely on sight have disadvantage on attack rolls against creatures draped in this shadow.

While the aura lasts, the paladin can use a bonus action on his or her turn to cause the shadows in the aura to attack one creature. The paladin makes a melee spell attack against the target. If the attack hits, the target takes necrotic damage equal to 3d10 + the paladin's Charisma modifier.

After activating the aura, the paladin can't do so again until he or she finishes a long rest.

OATHBREAKER ATONEMENT

If you allow a player to choose the Oathbreaker option, you can later allow the paladin to atone and become a true paladin once more.

The paladin who wishes to atone must first shed his or her evil alignment and demonstrate this alignment change through words and deeds. Having done so, the paladin loses all Oathbreaker features and must choose a deity and a sacred oath. (With your permission, the player can select a different deity or sacred oath than the character had previously.) However, the paladin doesn't gain the class features specific to that sacred oath until he or she completes some kind of dangerous quest or trial, as determined by the DM.

A paladin who breaks his or her sacred oath a second time can become an oathbreaker once more, but can't atone.

